

IB MYP Individuals & Societies (Grade 7) - The Big History Project

Task 1 - *Comparing crisis - Micro vs Macro perspective* (Scale switching)

The Close-up View (Micro): What did people experience directly in their daily lives, streets, or homes during the outbreak?

Category	The Black Death (1347 CE)	COVID-19 Pandemic (2020 CE)
How did families turn to each other inside the home? *(Micro-Scale Living & Household Dynamics)*	Storytelling around the hearth/campfire, playing board games, relying on close family in isolated households	SARS-CoV-2 (airborne coronavirus)
How did it spread globally? *(Macro-Scale Network)*	Merchant ships & Silk Road caravans (Pax Mongolica trade routes)	Commercial air travel & global supply cargo lines
How did people protect themselve? *(Protection & Gear)*	Herbal bird masks (beacks filled with herbs) (miasma theory), leather coats, gloves	Medical masks, hand sanitizer, lockdowns, vaccines
How did the outbreak change where and how people worked? *(Economic Impact)*	Peasants demanded higher wages; breakdown of the feudal system	Shift to remote work/Zoom, e-commerce growth, supply chain disruptions



Task 1 . 2 - *The Micro-Scale* (Visual Diagram & Explanation)

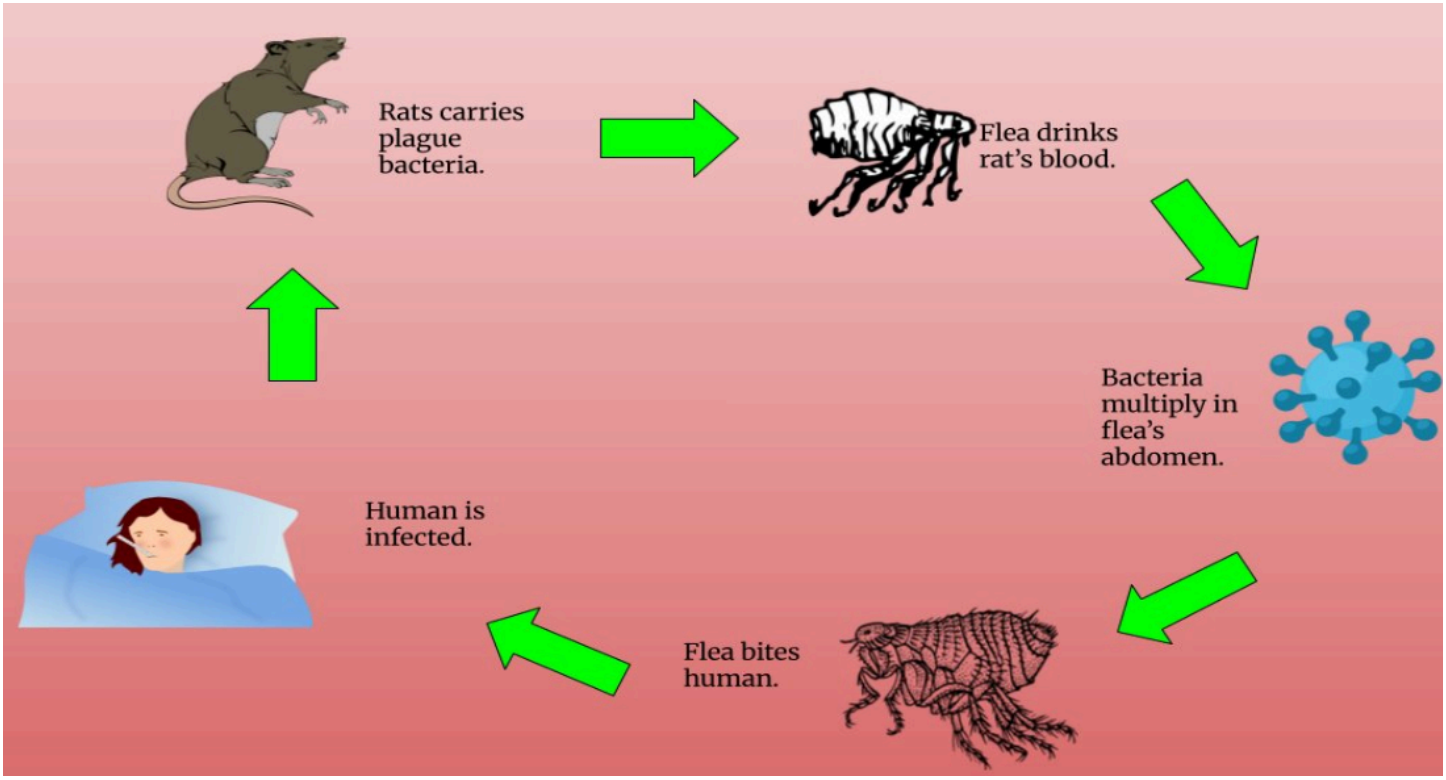
Draw the process how humans got the plague:

In the box below, draw the 3-step biological path showing how the Black Death (*Yersinia pestis*) spread from animals to humans based on the presentation slide.

Word Bank: Vector (noun / biology)

A living creature that carries a disease from an animal to a human without getting sick itself.
(Not the villain from Despicable Me!)

[Drawing: Animal Host ➔ Vector ➔ Human]



Written Explanation:

Explain in 1–2 sentences what is happening in your drawing and why this made the disease spread so quickly without people realizing it.

The drawing shows *Yersinia pestis* bacteria traveling from a wild animal host (the black rat) via an insect vector (the flea) to a human host. It spread so quickly and invisibly because people at the time did not understand microorganisms, mistaking transmission for bad air ("miasma theory") or divine punishment, meaning they had no idea fleas were biting them or carrying the invisible bacteria.

Task 2 - *Human behavior* VS *Environment* (Claim Testing)

1. Evaluate the claim: "Human reactions to sudden crisis haven't changed in 700 years; only our technology has." Answer the reflection questions below using specific historical evidence from the lesson.

1. by pointing out *continuity* in human behavior (By giving a example; panic, seeking isolation, looking for someone to blame/scapegoating, or trying to protect families .)

2. alongside *change* driven by technology and science (by giving a example; moving from herbal bird masks and miasma theories to modern germ theory, vaccines, and global digital communication via Zoom).

2. How did the labor shortage after the Black Death empower medieval peasants, and how is this similar to the shift toward remote work after COVID-19?

The massive population loss caused a severe labor shortage, meaning surviving peasants suddenly had high bargaining power to demand better wages and abandon the rigid feudal system.

COVID-19 connection: Similarly, the pandemic forced a sudden disruption where workers and employers realized jobs could be done remotely, giving employees more leverage to demand flexible work-from-home options and shifting traditional workplace expectations.

5-MINUTE SUMMATIVE EXIT TICKET

What economic shift occurred in Western Europe as a direct result of the Black Death's population loss?*

A. Feudal lords lowered peasant wages because food became scarce.

<<B. The feudal system broke down because surviving peasants could demand higher wages.>>

C. Trade along the Silk Road completely ended forever.

Final Reflection: Does history repeat itself? Answer in ONE sentence using today's lesson concepts.

Tear off and hand in before leaving

De naam van je Canva-profiel wordt niet gedeeld. Dien nooit wachtwoorden in.